national future … comes at a time when America feels unsure about its value in a number of domains: in world military politics, in global economies, in ecological practice, and in the claim that the nation has a commitment to sustaining justice, democracy, and the American Dream when there seems to be less money and reliable work to go around" (Berlant, *Queen of America Goes to Washington City*, 18). Such scholars suggest the ways the memory debates are interrelated—whether about the Holocaust or the Vietnam War—to continuing policies and attitudes about U.S. military policy and culture. For more on AIDS memory, see Cvetkovich, "AIDS Activism and the Oral History Archive."

25. Oates and Johnson, *Journal of Joyce Carol Oates*, 409.

26. Joyce Carol Oates, "Ich bin ein Berliner," in Oates, *Last Days*, 99–100.

27. Joyce Carol Oates, "Our Wall" in Oates, *Last Days*, 241. If Oates was drawn closer to the Berlin Wall only to ultimately affirm its looming endurance and cyclical patterns of violence, visual artist Keith Haring's October 1986 mural painted directly on the western side of the Wall near Checkpoint Charlie on Zimmerstrasse countered her method with an embodied gesture of expression that doubled as a call to action against the structure. At the invitation of the Haus am Checkpoint Charlie, Haring's site-specific intervention occurred at a high point for prominent American artists, including Jonathan Borofsky and David Wojnarowicz, expressing themselves with painted imagery directly on the Berlin Wall's western surface, as well as a moment of his own rise to international acclaim. In one day, Haring painted a 300-foot-long section of the Berlin Wall, featuring interlinked human figures rendered in black, red, and yellow, the colors of the German flags. Haring told a newspaper, "It's a humanistic gesture, more than anything else … a political and subversive act—an attempt to psychologically destroy the wall by painting it" ("Keith Haring Paints Mural on Berlin Wall," *New York Times*, October 24, 1986). His monumental artwork imagined the reunion of the two Germanys, as he coded a variety of subtle physical symbols of difference within the interlocked figures' abstract elements. Despite his monumental aim, Haring's gesture toward making a spectacle of aspirational German solidarity drew criticism for an overemphasis on symbols suggestive of universality rather than political recognition. Haring employed a complex semiotic system of Xs and Os on the bodies of the figures to conjure diversity and difference. But whereas many of his other contemporary public projects drew on site-specific political provocation, the mural lacked a direct, multilevel acknowledgment of German history beyond abstraction. While on the scene, however, Haring successfully drew attention to his own transnational project of grassroots public action in coverage surrounding the event. In a televised press conference at the Haus am Checkpoint Charlie, Haring drew attention to another region and crucible of political conflict: he wore a self-designed "Free South Africa" t-shirt, symbolically linking his mural on the Berlin Wall to his global antiapartheid advocacy. Within days of its creation, Haring's Berlin Wall mural was painted over by other artists, and audiences lost the opportunity to make connections between the Berlin Wall, scars of memory, and contemporary global conflicts. Haring also has a sculpture, *Boxer*, installed near West Berlin's Potsdamer Platz in 1987. For more on Haring, see Gruen, *Keith Haring*. For more on other Wall painters, see Gray, "Wall Painters." For more on Borofsky's painting on the Berlin Wall and public art/sculptures in Germany, see Rosenthal, Borofsky, and Marshall, *Jonathan Borofsky*, and Farber, *Wall in Our Heads*. For more on Wojnarowicz's cow's head paintings on the Berlin Wall, images of the Berlin Zoo, and the adapted performance of his written monologues, *Sounds in the Distance*, in Berlin in 1984 (starring Allen Frame, John Edward Heys, and others, and accompanied by Nan Goldin), see DWP and JEHP.

28. Dhairyam, "'Artifacts for Survival,'" 249. For more on the historical strategies of *Our Dead Behind Us*, see also Gloria Hull, "Living on the Line: Audre Lorde and *Our Dead Behind Us*," in Wall, *Changing Our Own Words*.

29. Ilona Pache and Regina-Maria Dackweiler, "An Interview with Audre Lorde" (1987), in Lorde and Hall, *Conversations with Audre Lorde*, 166.

30. Lorde, *Our Dead Behind Us*, 3–5.